

Practice Quiz: Action — Every Move Is an Experiment

Part A: Multiple Choice

1. In active inference, every action you take is best described as: A) A random guess B) Your brain testing a prediction about what will happen C) A waste of time D) Something you do without any thought

Answer: B — Every action is an experiment where your brain predicts the outcome and then observes what actually happens.

1. You walk up to someone and say "Hey, that presentation was really cool." Your heart is pounding because: A) You're out of shape B) Your brain is dealing with high uncertainty about the outcome C) Compliments are dangerous D) You forgot what you were going to say

Answer: B — Uncertainty about how the other person will respond makes the action feel scary.

1. When you try out for the basketball team and don't make it, what did you gain? A) Nothing — it was a total failure B) Real data about your skill level, the competition, and what you need to practice C) Proof that you should never try anything again D) A reason to quit sports forever

Answer: B — Even when things don't go as planned, you get valuable data that updates your models.

1. Why do some actions feel terrifying while others feel easy? A) Some actions are always hard for everyone B) The level of uncertainty about the outcome changes how the action feels C) Easy actions are better actions D) Terrifying actions are always bad ideas

Answer: B — The same action (like raising your hand) feels different depending on how uncertain you are.

1. Your brain makes uncertain actions feel uncomfortable because: A) Your brain wants you to be miserable B) It's trying to protect you from potential bad outcomes C) Discomfort is random D) It's a sign you should never take risks

Answer: B — Your brain's discomfort signal evolved to protect you, though it sometimes overreacts in safe situations.

1. A **micro-experiment** is: A) A tiny science fair project B) A small, low-risk action that teaches you something without big consequences C) Something only scientists do D) A huge life-changing decision

Answer: B — Micro-experiments let you learn and reduce uncertainty without taking big risks.

1. Instead of trying to become best friends with someone all at once, a good micro-experiment would be: A) Write them a 10-page letter about your feelings B) Say hi in the hallway and see how they respond C) Ignore them completely D) Ask them to be your best friend immediately

Answer: B — Starting small reduces risk, gives you data, and builds confidence for bigger actions.

1. The result of each action gives you: A) A grade B) Data that updates your mental models C) Nothing useful D) A punishment

Answer: B — Whether the outcome is good or bad, you learn something that updates your understanding.

1. The "hack" for dealing with the discomfort of uncertain actions is: A) Avoid all uncomfortable situations B) Remind yourself the discomfort is a signal about uncertainty, not a warning about danger C) Wait until you feel 100% confident before doing anything D) Let someone else do it for you

Answer: B — Recognizing discomfort as an uncertainty signal rather than a danger signal helps you act anyway.

1. Taking small actions is like leveling up in a game because: A) You skip all the hard parts B) You start with small challenges, gain experience, and build up to bigger ones C) You always win D) There's no challenge involved

Answer: B — Each small action builds your experience and confidence for taking on bigger challenges.

Part B: Short Answer

1. Describe an action you've been putting off because of uncertainty. What's the smallest version of that action you could take as a micro-experiment?
2. Think of a time when you took an action that didn't go the way you planned. What data did you gain from the experience? How did it update your model?
3. Why is it harder to ask a question in a new class where you don't know anyone compared to a class where you feel comfortable? Use the concept of uncertainty in your answer.
4. Give an example of three micro-experiments someone could do if they wanted to start a YouTube channel but were scared to begin.
5. Describe a time when taking a small action reduced your uncertainty about something and made a bigger action easier later on.